



**Gurdwara Guru Granth Sahib
Punjabi School**

Child Protection and Safeguarding Policy

We, at Punjabi School actively promote the welfare and wellbeing of its employees/Volunteers and of all children, young people and adults. In particular, as an organisation we are committed to ensuring:

- children's and young people's rights to care and protection from harm in any form are firmly upheld as outlined within United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC)
- adult learners' personal interests, dignity and care, protection from harm are safeguarded;
- we fulfil our legislative duties related to safeguarding, including child protection;
- the interests of all staff are safeguarded as they go about their work and engage with learners of all ages; and
- all staff, should be suitably trained in how to respond to safeguarding matters.

What does it mean by Child Protection and Safeguarding?

Child Protection – The processes involved in consideration, assessment and planning of required action, together with the actions themselves, where there are concerns that a child may be at risk of harm from abuse, neglect or exploitation.

Safeguarding - This is a much wider concept than child protection and refers to promoting the welfare of children, young people and protected adults. It encompasses protecting from maltreatment, preventing impairment of their health or development, ensuring that they are growing up in circumstances consistent with the provision of safe and effective care; and taking action to enable all children, young people and protected adults to have the best outcomes. Child protection is part of this definition and refers to activities undertaken to prevent children suffering, or likely to suffer, significant harm.

In Scotland, they have a distinctive approach to safeguarding linked to Getting It Right for Every Child (GIRFEC) which promotes action to improve the wellbeing of every child and young person. Safeguarding is a golden thread that runs through the curriculum. The aim is to support the development of learner's knowledge, skills and resilience to keep themselves safe and protected, and to develop an

understanding of the world so that they can respond to a range of issues and potential risky situations arising throughout their lives. As such, it permeates many features of the education experience including leadership, values, vision, the curriculum, learning and teaching, positive relationships, building learner resilience and suchlike.

In all Education work, the needs, interests and wellbeing of children and young people and protected adults must be put above the needs and interests of all others. Hence, this Policy and the guidance contained within it must have priority over all other policies and advice.

Safeguarding Policy

This policy provides the framework within which our staff, individually and collectively, can understand their responsibilities in relation to safeguarding/child protection and promoting the welfare of children (1) and protected adults (2) .

1. Differing legal definitions of the age of a 'child' can be confusing. The priority is to ensure that a vulnerable young person who is or may be at risk of harm is offered support and protection. References within this policy to children are intended to refer to children and young people up to the age of 18 years.

2. A protected adult is defined as an individual aged 16 or over who is provided with (and thus receives) a type of care, support or welfare service. Protected adult is therefore a service based definition and avoids labelling adults on the basis of them having a specific condition or disability.

Educators in Punjabi School : They will enable children, young people and adults to be safe, nurtured, achieving, healthy, active, included, respected and responsible; children, young people and adults to become successful learners, confident individuals, responsible citizens and effective contributors in centres of learning, the workplace and the community.

We will do this by :

- always putting the needs of, and desired outcomes for, children and adult learners in centre of learning, the workplace and the community at the forefront;
- accounting rigorously and clearly to them, their families, on the quality of education and other services; and
- promoting high quality equitable outcomes for all learners by eliminating inequity that exists amongst learners from different backgrounds and particular vulnerable groups.

In carrying this out, staff recognise their professional and legal obligations to protect children, young people and adult learners, particularly those at risk. They will promote safe practice to protect children, young people and adults from harm, abuse and exploitation.

This policy aims to ensure that:

- We, at Punjabi School Management Team operates a robust and safe selection and appointment process which requires all employees/Volunteers who have opportunities to engage regularly with children in the course of their normal duties be members of the Protecting Vulnerable Groups (PVG) Scheme and to participate in relevant professional learning;
- during all forms of engagement, we create a safe environment for children, young people and adults at risk, and the adults who work with them;
- All staff are equipped with the information, knowledge, support and guidance to keep children, young people and adults at risk, safe and protected; and
- we take account of local inter-agency child protection guidelines and each local authority's legal obligation to safeguard and protect any group at risk, including children and protected adults.

Principles of this Policy

- The welfare and rights of all children, young people and protected adults are always the primary concern;

- Protecting children, young people and protected adults is everyone's responsibility;
- Every child, young person and protected adult should be treated as an individual and has a right to a positive sense of identity. Article 8 (right to preserve identity);
- All children, young people and protected adults have the right to be protected from all forms of abuse, neglect and exploitation. Article 19 (protection from all forms of abuse or neglect);
- All children, young people and protected adults have the right to express their views on matters affecting them.

Article 12 (right to have views taken into account on all matters that affect them).

To promote these principles we will:

- Treat everyone with respect and encourage children, young people and protected adults to respect others;
 - Promote the rights, including privacy and dignity, of children, young people and protected adults as defined by the United Nations Convention on the Rights of the Child (UNCRC));
- Respect confidentiality and only share information and concerns about children, young people and protected adults with those who need to know;
- Take action to stop any inappropriate verbal or physical behaviour and emotional abuse, including bullying;
- Treat all concerns and allegations seriously and respond appropriately, operating within our agreed policy, procedures and guidance; and
- Refer our concerns, not investigate.

Everyone has a responsibility to protect young people and protected adults.
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Every child, young person and protected adult, at all times, has a right to feel safe and protected from any situation or practice which may result in harm.

Above all, the welfare of children, young people and protected adults is the paramount consideration and we must all work together to ensure they are protected

Instances:- <http://www.gov.scot/Resource/0045/00450733.pdf>

The 'Common Core of Skills, Knowledge & Understanding and Values for the "Children's Workforce" In Scotland' (2012) -

<http://www.gov.scot/Resource/0039/00395179.pdf>

Punjabi School Child protection policy shows equality and diversity issues. We must access to, and delivery of, child protection services to be fair, consistent, reliable and focused on individual outcomes and enablement. In our policy service users would be listened to, respected and responded to. There should be no discrimination on the grounds of race, disability, gender, age, sexual orientation, religion or belief, gender reassignment.

- Non-discrimination;
- Best interests of the child;
- The child's right to life, survival and development; and
- Respecting the views of the child.

Summary of responsibilities of our staff

Staff does not have direct responsibility for the delivery of services, or for investigating matters related to safeguarding or child protection.

We are committed to promoting the welfare and wellbeing of its employees and all children, young people and adults who staff come in contact with during all our work. Safeguarding is the responsibility of everyone in Education Scotland regardless of their individual role.

This policy, together with our Safeguarding code of practice and guidance and appropriate professional learning will support our staff in fulfilling their safeguarding responsibilities and duties. We have

both an internal safeguarding role in terms of supporting staff in dealing with safeguarding responsibilities and duties as well as an outward facing role through capacity building, inspection and review and providing professional policy advice.

We will support all our staff and ensure they;

- are appointed following appropriate and stringent safe recruitment procedures;
- are supported through appropriate professional learning to raise their awareness of the need for safeguarding children, young people and protected adults, know their responsibilities and are familiar with the procedures to follow when they have concerns; and
- take actions to respond to allegations, suspicions or incidents of abuse and ensure all safeguarding concerns are shared with the relevant head of establishment in order that they can take appropriate action.

We will support and promote the development of the 'Getting it right for every child approach to safeguarding' through a responsive, flexible and inclusive framework within Curriculum for Excellence. The aim is to support the development of children's and young people's knowledge, skills and resilience to keep themselves safe and protected and to develop an understanding of the world so that they can respond to a range of issues and potential risky situations arising throughout their lives.

We will:

- ensure a strong focus on how well education providers carry out their responsibilities in a manner which safeguards children, young people and protected adults;
- evaluate how well education providers have appropriate safeguarding procedures in place.

Concerns

- Ensure that staff are clear of protocols and take positive actions to respond to allegations, suspicions or incidents of abuse;

- Record all concerns using relevant safeguarding reports, and monitor follow-up activity to ensure all appropriate action is taken;
- Monitor the nature and the outcome of causes of concern to identify patterns; and
- Take action to ensure the School Management Team is informed where a safeguarding allegation is made against any member of staff.
- Ensure that all staff are aware of the need for safeguarding children, young people and protected adults and that staff are familiar with the procedures to follow when they have concerns;

Reporting

- Provide regular reporting on safeguarding practice to the School Management Team;